

ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM (540)

—Post-secondary—

NATIONAL – 2019

FINAL

TOTAL POINTS

_____ (160)

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts. Failure to do so will result in disqualification.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests or facsimile (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

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Case Study

All office copy equipment and maintenance for your company have been contracted with a local vendor for the past 20 years. That partners (who are brothers) of the local vendor have recently split with one partner opening a store in a nearby town.

Not long after that split, all new office copy equipment was purchased from the brother in the nearby town. The financial administrative assistant for the company mailed a receipt for that purchase to the longstanding vendor in error. Upon discovery of this purchase, he approached the company executive asking why that purchase was not offered to him first or even the opportunity to bid. The executive stated, "You both benefit from this so what does it matter?"

Not satisfied with the executive's answer, he requests a copy of the contract. Upon reading the contract, he discovers that the company was given an initial deduction for maintenance but in two years the price of maintenance will drastically increase.

- What relationships are jeopardized in this situation?
- Did the executive handle this confrontation appropriately?
- What inferences materialized?
- Was it okay for the company to provide a copy of the contract?
- What ethical violations may have occurred?
- Is there any recourse the long-standing vendor has?